



	Cooler Master	Cooler Master	Deepcool	Deepcool	Cooler Master	Noctua	Noctua
	Hyper 412 Slim	TPC 612	ICE WARRIOR	NEPTWIN	TPC 812	NH-U12S	NH-U14S
	3,000	3,300	3,650	3,900	4,300	4,900	5,500
	13.54	13.25	14.67	12.54	12.38	16.17	16.17
	64	59.73	64.11	63.38	59.89	63.64	65.44
	77.54	72.98	78.78	75.92	72.26	79.80	81.60
	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)
	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)	(Y/Y/Y/Y/Y)
	128x70x160	134x85x161.6	136X84X156	126X136X159	134x74x158	125x71x158	165x52x152
	Single Tower	Single Tower	Single Tower	Twin Tower	Single Tower	Single Tower	Single Tower
	2/120mm	1/120mm	1/120mm	2/120mm	1/120mm	1/120mm	1/140mm
	1600	2000	1500	1500	2400	1500	1500
	Sleeve	Rifle	Hydro	Hydro	Sleeve	SS02 Hydro	SS02 Hydro
	4	4	6	6	6	5	6
	538	640	1080	1109	826	755	770
	(N/N/Y/N)	(N/N/N/Y)	(N/N/N/Y)	(N/N/N/Y)	(N/N/N/Y)	(N/N/N/Y)	(N/N/N/Y)
	N/Y/N	Y/Y/N	N/Y/Y	N/Y/N	Y/Y/N	N/Y/Y	N/Y/Y
	Direct	Indirect	Indirect	Indirect	Indirect	Indirect	Indirect
	N/Y/Y/N	Y/N/Y/Y	N/N/Y/Y	Y/N/Y/N	Y/N/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y/Y	Y/Y/Y/Y
	(Y/N/N)	(N/N/N)	(N/Y/N)	(Y/N/N)	(N/N/N)	(N/N/Y)	(N/N/Y)
	31.25	33	31.25	31	31	32	30.75
	51.25	50	51	52.75	50.5	51.75	48.25
	Silent	Dull Hum	Silent	Silent	Dull Hum	Silent	Silent
	7	6	8	9	7	6	6

We were happy to see the strong and extra fan mounts included with both the TPC 612 and TPC 812 coolers. Since Cooler Master has merged two cooling techniques into one for both the coolers, the output given in terms of performance is good but not great and the products seem to be confused about what they are aiming for. The fan on the TPC 612 and TPC 812 can be heard outside the case and this is also a deterrent when you are gunning for a silent and performing CPU cooler. Then we have the Deepcool ICE WARRIOR which is a

decent performer whose installation is cumbersome and requires time and patience.

The aluminium fins on the ICE WARRIOR are built sturdily and it has an "X" pattern on either sides. There are six heat pipes which run through the heatsink. Deepcool has also included a rubber coated fan with blue fins and a black frame with the ICE WARRIOR. The boxed accessories also include a 3-pin to Molex converter cable. Performance wise the Deepcool ICE WARRIOR is slightly below Deepcool's own NEPTWIN.

Finally, the two remaining air coolers we received were from Noctua, the Noctua NH-U12S and the Noctua NH-U14S. We must say that we were impressed with the packaging of both the coolers as it was very organised and we could easily pick out the required parts for installation. Noctua also one-upped their package by including a screw driver, a Low Noise Adapter (LNA) and their famous NT-H1 premium thermal paste tube. Both the Noctua coolers came with a metal case badge as well. Speaking of them indi-

vidually, The Noctua NH-U14S came with a 140mm Noctua NF-A15 silent fan and it shines in performance. Unfortunately the same can't be said for the Noctua NH-U12S, though it has a nice feature set with plenty of accessories, it still lacks in performance.

VERDICT: AIR COOLERS

Out of all the air coolers we received, some were good, some were bad and some were mediocre. Cooler Master Hyper TX3 Evo won the Best Buy award as it is dirt cheap and should be considered by anyone who wants to replace his/her stock cooler with a better performing yet budget friendly cooler. The cooler that stood out in terms of performance and won our Best Performer award is the Noctua NH-U14S as its idle as well as load temperatures were the least in the test, it was very silent and it also received points for its wealthy list of features and accessories although it is expensive.

Deepcool FROSTWIN available for only 2.9k was the next best cooler in terms of performance and it received the Editor's Pick award. But you can also go for the Cooler Master Hyper 212X as it's an amazing cooler at the price and is completely worth the money.

LIQUID COOLERS

It's said that "the better the surface area, the better the cooling". Air coolers have limited surface area to offer as compared to liquid coolers. Liquid coolers, as the name suggests, have liquids like coolant or plain distilled water running inside. No, that doesn't mean that you will have to submerge your precious computer components in water. Basically, a liquid cooler contains a pump,